

Convertible Arbitrage Market

Numeric Time-Series Data Pack · 2023 to August / September 2026

Eight series covering the convertible-arbitrage opportunity set: equity and rate volatility, high-yield credit spreads, new-issue cheapness, strategy and index returns, primary issuance, and the equity benchmark. Every figure in this pack is a sourced observation — nothing is interpolated, smoothed, or filled. Where a series has a genuine coverage gap, the gap is drawn and labelled rather than bridged.

#	Series	Coverage in this pack	Primary source
1	CBOE VIX index	Annual averages 2022–25; four confirmed monthly averages	FRED (VIXCLS)
2	ICE BofA MOVE index	Full 2025 month-end closes; 2023/24/26 anchors only	Convex Trade
3	ICE BofA US HY OAS	36 consecutive month-ends, Sep 2023 – Aug 2026	FRED (BAMLH0A0HYM2)
4	New-issue cheapness	Six confirmed quarters, points cheap to theoretical	Matthews South
5	HFRX Convertible Arb	Annual 2023–25; eight confirmed monthly prints	HFR
6	ICE BofA VXA0	Annual total return 2023–26 YTD; 2025 monthly	Calamos / ICE BofA
7	Convertible issuance	US and global, annual and quarterly, by provider	Multiple — see §7
8	S&P 500	33 monthly closes; annual total returns	multpl.com / Calamos

Prepared 2 September 2026. Latest observation in the pack: 1 September 2026 (S&P 500); most risk series run through 31 August 2026.

Summary

Convertible arbitrage delivered a genuine three-year tailwind, and the data show why: the profit engine shifted away from equity beta and toward structural mechanics — cheap new-issue pricing, record primary supply, and rich single-stock volatility — precisely as macro volatility normalised.

What the numbers establish

- **The strategy worked, three years running.** HFRX Convertible Arbitrage returned **+10.1%** (2023), **+6.82%** (2024) and **+12.78%** (2025), with **+2.48%** in January 2026 alone.
- **Volatility normalised sharply.** HY OAS fell from **4.42%** (Oct 2023) to **2.63%** (31 Aug 2026), a cycle low. MOVE fell from a **~199** peak (Mar 2023) to **63.96** (Dec 2025) and **75.32** (Aug 2026). VIX annual averages ran 16.85 → 15.55 → 18.93.
- **New paper stayed cheap.** Matthews South put new-issue cheapness at roughly **2 points** through 2023–2025 (FY2024 avg 2.5 pts; FY2025 avg 2.0 pts) — then it converged to **1.1 pts** in Q1 2026, with February 2026 averaging just **0.1 pts**.
- **Supply was a record.** US issuance ran ~\$55bn (2023) → ~\$88bn (2024) → ~\$124bn (2025), the most active US year on record; global 2025 landed between \$140.5bn and \$167.1bn depending on provider.
- **Convertibles kept pace with equities in 2025.** VXA0 returned **+18.0%** against the S&P 500's **+17.9%** — while the market-neutral arb sleeve made +12.78% with near-zero equity beta, which is the differentiating point for an allocator.

The one event to annotate on every chart

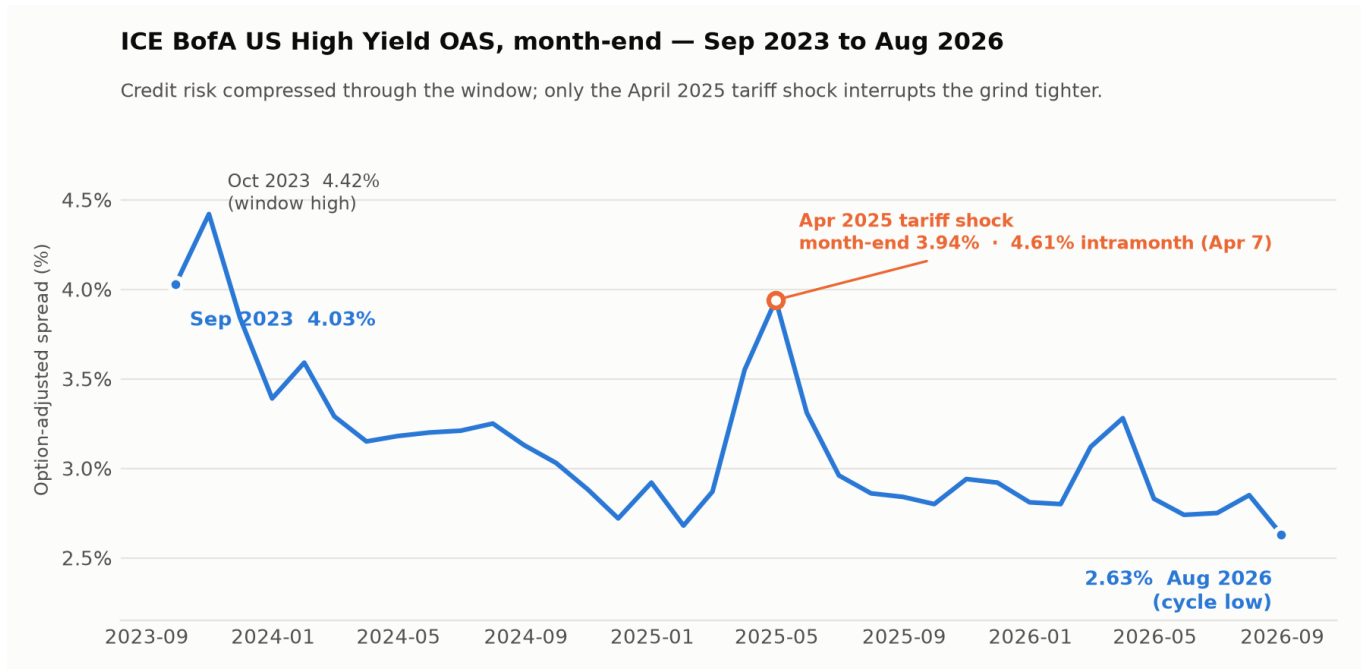
The **April 2025 tariff shock** is visible simultaneously in every risk series: HY OAS spiked to **4.61%** intramonth on 7 April (month-end 3.94%), MOVE reached **139.88** intramonth (month-end 112.48), and the S&P 500 troughed at **5,369.50**. It is the single most important marker on any 2023–2026 convert-arb chart.

Where the data are genuinely incomplete

Two granular gaps could not be closed from free sources, and are shown as gaps rather than estimated: **full daily/monthly VIX before 2026** (retrievable from FRED, not transcribed here) and **MOVE month-ends for 2023–2024** (only anchors are publicly retrievable free of charge). A third, narrower gap: FRED now retains only three years of the HY OAS series, so January–August 2023 month-ends sit outside the free window. Section 6 lists every gap; section 7 says how to close each one.

1. Credit spreads and volatility

1.1 ICE BofA US High Yield option-adjusted spread



Month-end	OAS	Month-end	OAS	Month-end	OAS
2023-09-29	4.03%	2024-09-30	3.03%	2025-09-30	2.80%
2023-10-31	4.42%	2024-10-31	2.88%	2025-10-31	2.94%
2023-11-30	3.84%	2024-11-29	2.72%	2025-11-30	2.92%
2023-12-31	3.39%	2024-12-31	2.92%	2025-12-31	2.81%
2024-01-31	3.59%	2025-01-31	2.68%	2026-01-30	2.80%
2024-02-29	3.29%	2025-02-28	2.87%	2026-02-28	3.12%
2024-03-31	3.15%	2025-03-31	3.55%	2026-03-31	3.28%
2024-04-30	3.18%	2025-04-30	3.94%	2026-04-30	2.83%
2024-05-31	3.20%	2025-05-30	3.31%	2026-05-29	2.74%
2024-06-30	3.21%	2025-06-30	2.96%	2026-06-30	2.75%
2024-07-31	3.25%	2025-07-31	2.86%	2026-07-31	2.85%
2024-08-30	3.13%	2025-08-31	2.84%	2026-08-31	2.63%

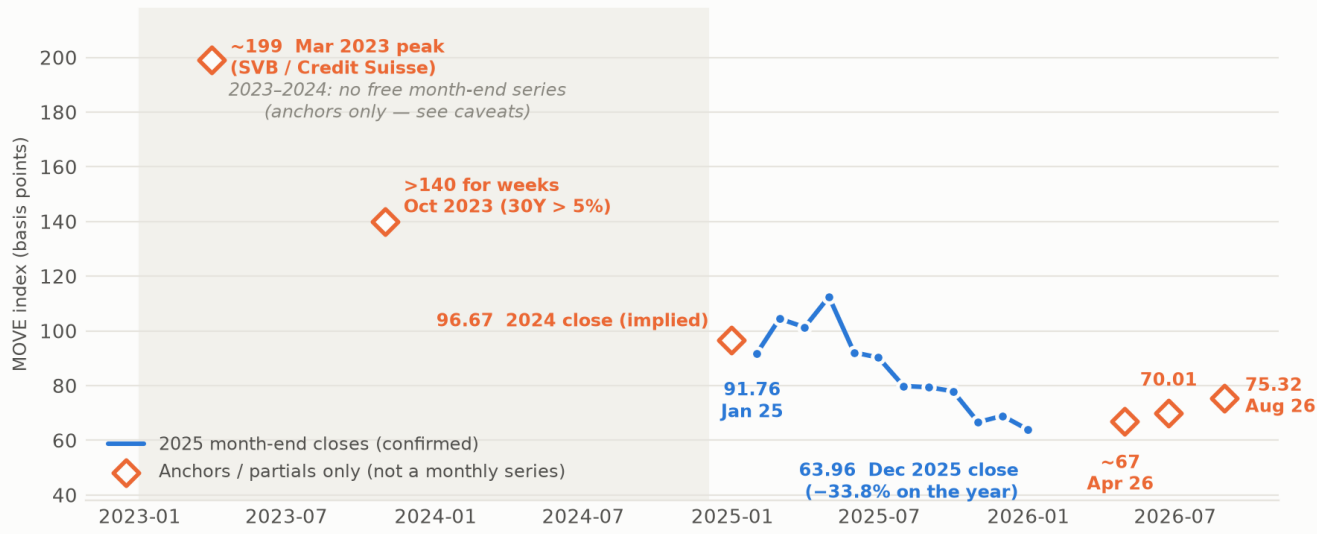
All 36 month-ends in the free FRED window. Intramonth high of 4.61% on 7 Apr 2025 is not a month-end and is not in this table.

Source: FRED series BAMLH0A0HYM2 (fred.stlouisfed.org/data/BAMLH0A0HYM2), daily table reduced to month-ends. Daily series ran through 2026-08-31 at time of pull.

1.2 ICE BofA MOVE index — rate volatility

ICE BofA MOVE index — confirmed 2025 monthly closes with 2023/24/26 anchors

Rate volatility fell by two-thirds from the March-2023 banking peak to the December-2025 close.



2025 month-end	Close (bp)	Intramonth high (bp)
2025-01-31	91.76	—
2025-02-28	104.46	—
2025-03-31	101.35	—
2025-04-30	112.48	139.88
2025-05-31	92.11	—
2025-06-30	90.26	—
2025-07-31	79.84	—
2025-08-31	79.39	—
2025-09-30	77.93	—
2025-10-31	66.61	—
2025-11-30	68.95	—
2025-12-31	63.96	—

The only fully confirmed monthly year in this series. 2025 closed -33.84% on the year.

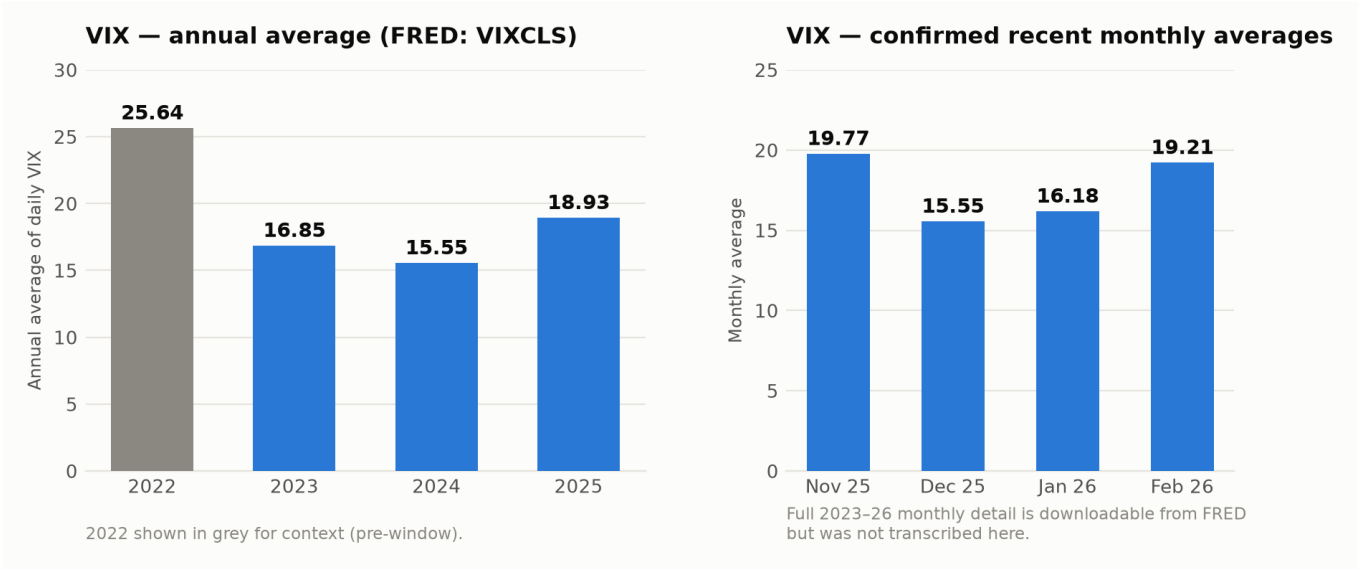
Anchors and partials outside 2025

Date	MOVE (bp)	What it is	Confidence
2023-03-31	199.00	March 2023 peak (SVB / Credit Suisse)	anchor-approx
2023-10-31	140.00	Oct 2023: above 140 for weeks (30Y > 5%)	anchor-approx
2024-12-31	96.67	2024 close (implied from -22.22% yr change)	anchor-implied
2025-12-31	63.96	2025 close (-33.84% on the year)	confirmed
2026-04-30	67.00	late April 2026	anchor-approx
2026-06-23	70.01	Jun 23 2026 spot	confirmed
2026-08-31	75.32	Aug 31 2026 month-end (Aug daily avg ~73.5)	confirmed

These are anchors, not a monthly series — do not connect them as a line. 2024 traded mostly below 120; the 2024 close is implied from the reported -22.22% annual change and the 2025 open.

Source: convextrade.com/metrics/move-index (anchors) and [/history/2025](https://convextrade.com/history/2025) (monthly table). Charles Schwab corroborates the ~200 March-2023 peak. Barchart and Investing.com monthly history sit behind premium or interactive gates.

1.3 CBOE VIX — equity volatility



Year	Annual average VIX
2022	25.64
2023	16.85
2024	15.55
2025	18.93

Month	Monthly average VIX
2025-11-30	19.77
2025-12-31	15.55
2026-01-31	16.18
2026-02-28	19.21

Only these four monthly averages were transcribed. The full daily series (2 Jan 1990 – 31 Aug 2026) and the complete monthly table are freely downloadable from FRED; see §7 for the refresh path.

Source: FRED series VIXCLS — fred.stlouisfed.org/series/VIXCLS (daily), [graph/?g=Rqre](https://fred.stlouisfed.org/graph/?g=Rqre) (monthly), [graph/?g=A58O](https://fred.stlouisfed.org/graph/?g=A58O) (annual).

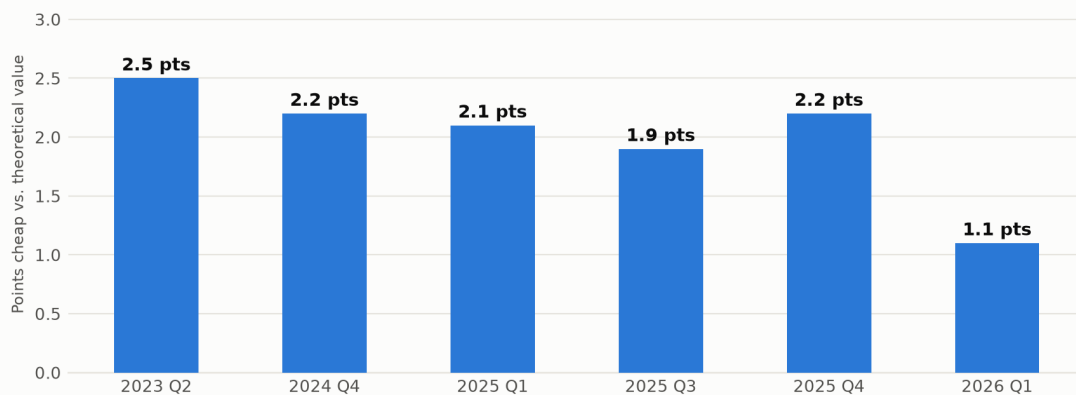
2. Convertible-arbitrage economics

2.1 New-issue cheapness

Cheapness is the strategy's cleanest structural edge: points by which new paper prices below model value, so a theoretical value of 102.5 means 2.5 points cheap (100 = fair).

Convertible new-issue cheapness — Matthews South quarterly reviews

New paper priced consistently cheap to model through 2023–2025 (FY2024 avg 2.5 pts, FY2025 avg 2.0 pts), then converged toward fair value in early 2026.



Quarters shown are the ones confirmed in sourcing. 2023 Q1/Q3/Q4, 2024 Q1–Q3 and 2025 Q2 were not confirmed and are omitted rather than interpolated.

Quarter	Points cheap	Trailing-12m avg	Note
2023 Q2	2.5	2.0	theoretical value 102.5 (100 = fair)
2024 Q4	2.2	—	FY2024 average 2.5
2025 Q1	2.1	2.4	—
2025 Q3	1.9	2.5	—
2025 Q4	2.2	—	FY2025 average 2.0
2026 Q1	1.1	1.8	Feb 2026 averaged just 0.1 pts

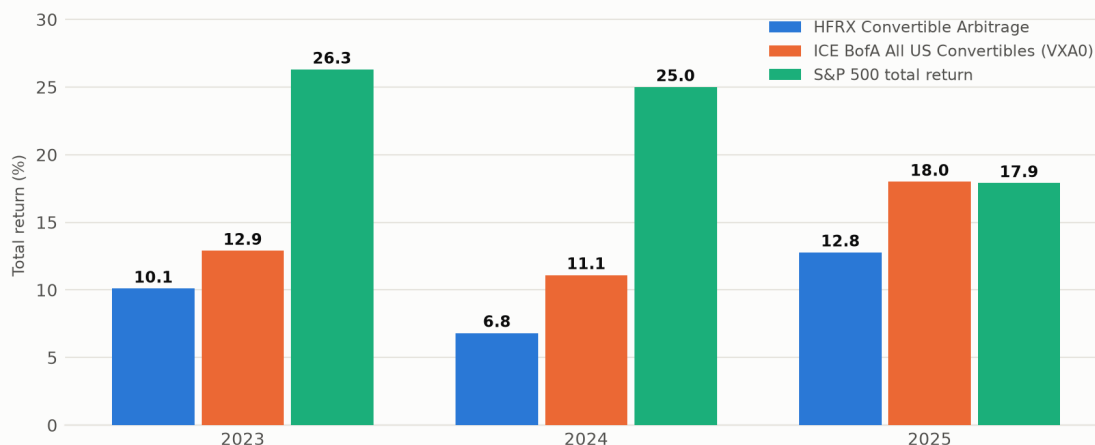
Not confirmed and therefore omitted: 2023 Q1, 2023 Q3, 2023 Q4, 2024 Q1, 2024 Q2, 2024 Q3, 2025 Q2. These require the corresponding individual Matthews South quarterly posts; they are left blank rather than interpolated.

Source: Matthews South quarterly Convertible Market Reviews — matthewssouth.com (q2-2023, 2024-year-end, q1-2025, q3-2025, 2025-year-end, q1-2026).

2.2 Strategy and index returns

Annual total return — convert-arb strategy, convertible index, and equities

In 2025 the convertible index (+18.0%) edged out the S&P 500 (+17.9%), while the market-neutral arb sleeve made +12.78% with near-zero equity beta.



Year	HFRX Conv. Arb.	VXA0 convertibles	S&P 500	Russell 2000
2023	10.10%	12.9%	26.3%	16.9%
2024	6.82%	11.1%	25.0%	11.5%
2025	12.78%	18.0%	17.9%	12.8%
2026	—	6.4%	0.7%	6.2%

2026 figures are year-to-date through roughly August and will move; the HFRX 2026 annual figure is not yet meaningful and is shown as —. All are total returns.

HFRX Convertible Arbitrage — confirmed monthly prints

Month	Return
2025-01-31	+1.61%
2025-02-28	+0.15%
2025-04-30	+1.15%
2025-05-31	+2.05%
2025-10-31	+1.72%
2025-11-30	-1.04%
2025-12-31	+0.20%
2026-01-31	+2.48%

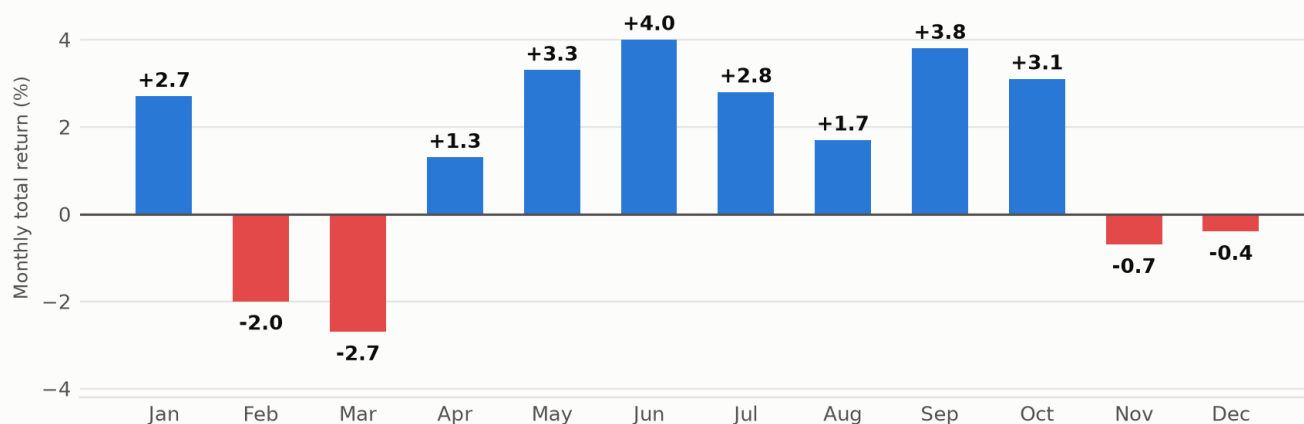
March and June–September 2025 monthly prints were not confirmed and are absent. HFR labels this index alternately “HFRX Convertible Arbitrage” and “HFRX Fixed Income Convertible Arbitrage” — confirm you are stitching one consistent index.

Source: HFR monthly performance notes, hfr.com/media/performance-notes/. The 2023 annual figure comes via HFR relayed by Resonanz Capital.

2.3 ICE BofA All US Convertibles (VXA0), 2025 monthly

ICE BofA All US Convertibles (VXA0) — 2025 monthly total return

Nine of twelve months positive; the Feb-Mar drawdown and the Nov-Dec fade bracket a strong Q2-Q3.



Month	Return	Month	Return
2025-01-31	+2.7%	2025-07-31	+2.8%
2025-02-28	-2.0%	2025-08-31	+1.7%
2025-03-31	-2.7%	2025-09-30	+3.8%
2025-04-30	+1.3%	2025-10-31	+3.1%
2025-05-31	+3.3%	2025-11-30	-0.7%
2025-06-30	+4.0%	2025-12-31	-0.4%

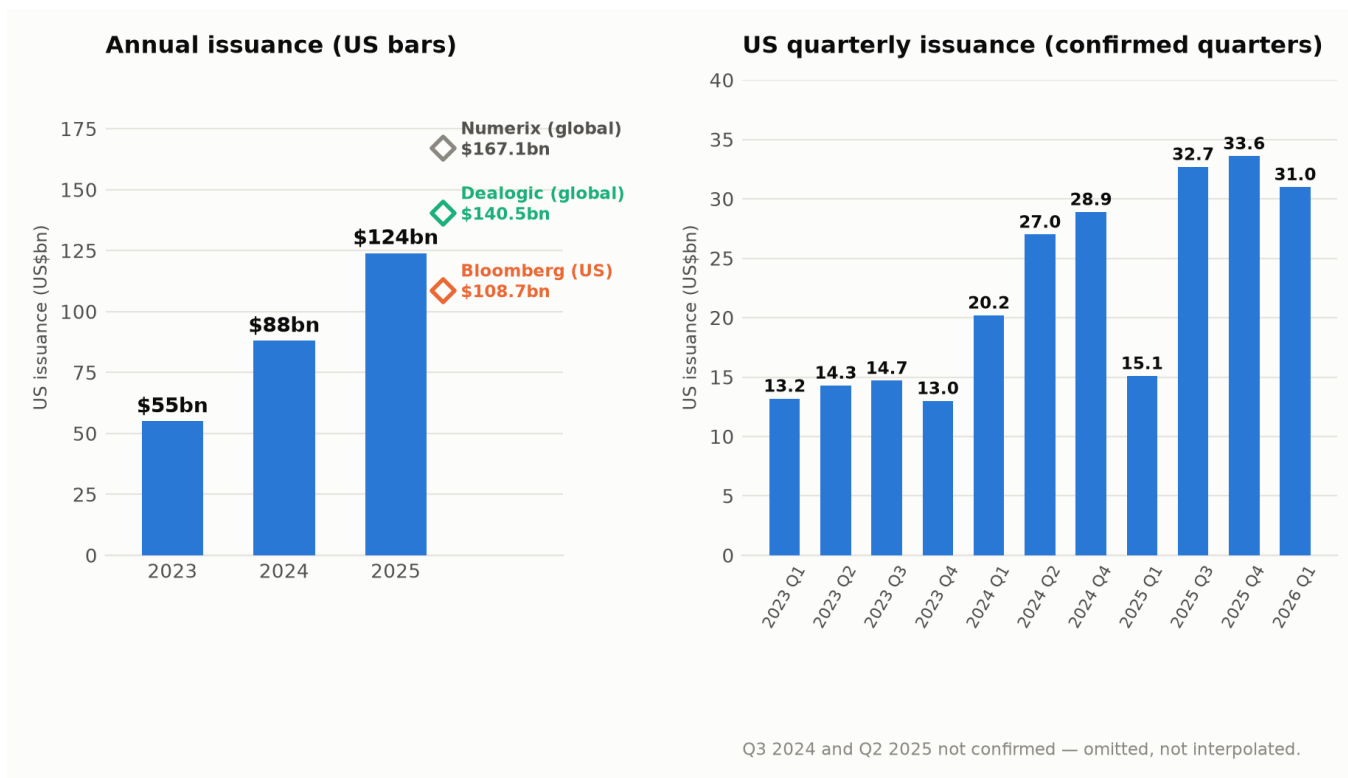
Market statistics at 31 December 2025

Measure	VXA0 (all US convertibles)	VNEW (new issues, last 6 months)
Average current yield	2.0%	1.4%
Average conversion premium	35.8%	40.8%
Average investment premium	—	33.8%

Source: Calamos “US Convertible Market Snapshot” (Dec 2025), data from ICE BofA Global Research. Corroboration: Invesco/Columbia commentary cited the ICE BofA US Convertible Index at +11.14% for 2024; Matthews South noted the Bloomberg convertible index up roughly 18% in 2025.

3. Primary issuance

Issuance is where provider scope matters most. Matthews South and Bloomberg track the **US** market; Numerix, BofA Global Research and Dealogic track **global**. The three 2025 figures below — \$124bn, \$140.5bn, \$167.1bn — are not contradictory; they are different universes and different inclusion rules. Normalise to one scope before charting.



Year	US — Matthews South	US — Bloomberg	Global — Numerix	Global — BofA	Global — Dealogic
2023	\$55.0bn	—	—	—	—
2024	\$88.0bn	—	—	—	\$96.1bn
2025	\$124.0bn	\$108.7bn	\$167.1bn	\$166.5bn	\$140.5bn
2026	—	—	—	—	\$85.5bn

2026 Dealogic figure is year-to-date as of early June 2026 (\$85.5bn across 127 deals), not a full year. 2025 US totals: \$124bn across 152 offerings (Matthews South) — the most active US year on record; Bloomberg reported \$108.7bn as of 13 Nov 2025, past the \$105.6bn 2020 record.

Quarterly detail

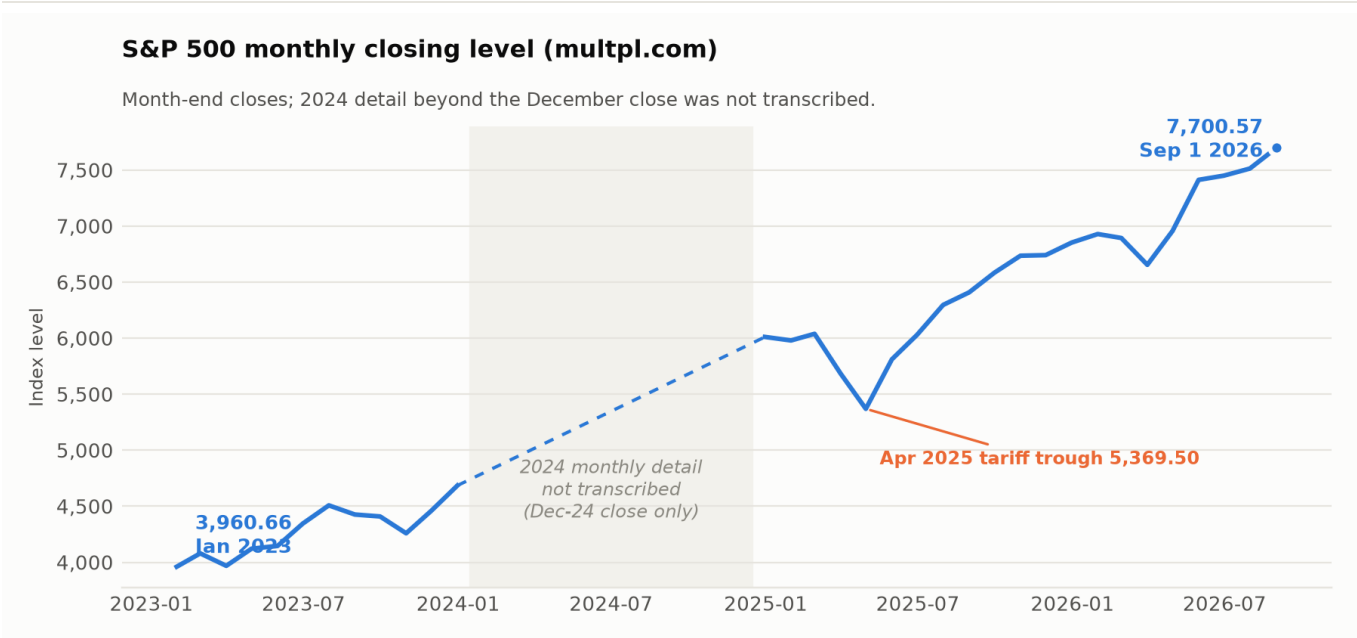
Quarter	US (\$bn)	US deals	Global (\$bn)	Global deals
2023 Q1	13.2	—	—	—
2023 Q2	14.3	24	—	—
2023 Q3	14.7	—	—	—
2023 Q4	13.0	—	—	—
2024 Q1	20.2	30	—	—
2024 Q2	27.0	—	—	—
2024 Q3	—	—	—	—

Quarter	US (\$bn)	US deals	Global (\$bn)	Global deals
2024 Q4	28.9	31	—	—
2025 Q1	15.1	22	25.3	—
2025 Q2	—	—	50.7	69
2025 Q3	32.7	52	49.4	—
2025 Q4	33.6	39	41.7	59
2026 Q1	31.0	38	35.9	75
2026 Q2	—	—	49.5	52

Q3 2024 and Q2 2025 US figures were not confirmed. Regional colour for Q2 2025 (Numerix): North America 49 deals / ~\$37.9bn — more than half of global issuance, average deal size ~\$773m; Europe up 231% year-on-year to \$5.3bn; APAC nearly doubled from \$6.2bn in Q2 to \$11.6bn in Q3.

Sources: Matthews South quarterly reviews (US); Numerix global convertibles issuance reports (global); ION Analytics / Dealogic (2026 YTD and full-year 2025); Bloomberg (13 Nov 2025, "US Convertible Bonds Top Covid Record With \$109 Billion Haul").

4. Equity context



Month	Close	Month	Close	Month	Close
2023-01-31	3,960.66	2023-12-31	4,685.05	2025-10-31	6,735.69
2023-02-28	4,079.68	2024-12-31	6,010.91	2025-11-30	6,740.89
2023-03-31	3,968.56	2025-01-31	5,979.52	2025-12-31	6,853.03
2023-04-30	4,121.47	2025-02-28	6,038.69	2026-01-31	6,929.12
2023-05-31	4,146.17	2025-03-31	5,683.98	2026-02-28	6,893.81
2023-06-30	4,345.37	2025-04-30	5,369.50	2026-03-31	6,654.42
2023-07-31	4,508.08	2025-05-31	5,810.92	2026-04-30	6,957.01
2023-08-31	4,426.24	2025-06-30	6,029.95	2026-05-31	7,412.55
2023-09-30	4,409.10	2025-07-31	6,296.50	2026-06-30	7,450.03
2023-10-31	4,258.98	2025-08-31	6,408.95	2026-07-31	7,513.50
2023-11-30	4,460.06	2025-09-30	6,584.02	2026-09-01	7,700.57

2024 is represented by its December close only — the intervening monthly closes were not transcribed and the chart shows that stretch as a dashed bridge across a shaded gap, not as data. The final row is 1 Sep 2026, the latest observation in this pack.

Source: multpl.com/s-p-500-historical-prices/table/by-month (monthly closes); Calamos US Convertible Market Snapshot (annual total returns, shown in §2.2). For a global equity comparison line, use the MSCI ACWI factsheet or an ACWI ETF proxy — no clean ACWI monthly series was pulled. The FTSE Global Convertible Index returned +23.3% in 2025 per Calamos.

5. Data coverage and confidence

Read this table before using any series. “Complete” means every period in the stated window is present. “Partial” means real observations exist but periods are missing — they are omitted, never estimated. “Anchors only” means the series cannot be charted as a continuous line at that frequency.

Series	Frequency	Window	Status	Constraint
HY OAS (BAMLH0A0HYM2)	Monthly	Sep 2023 – Aug 2026	Complete	Jan–Aug 2023 outside FRED's 3-year free window
VIX (VIXCLS)	Annual	2022 – 2025	Complete	—
VIX (VIXCLS)	Monthly	Nov 2025 – Feb 2026	Partial	Full history downloadable from FRED; not transcribed
MOVE	Monthly	Jan – Dec 2025	Complete	—
MOVE	Monthly	2023, 2024, 2026	Anchors only	No free month-end source; premium/interactive gates
New-issue cheapness	Quarterly	Q2'23 – Q1'26	Partial	7 of 13 quarters unconfirmed
HFRX Convertible Arb.	Annual	2023 – 2025	Complete	—
HFRX Convertible Arb.	Monthly	2025 – Jan 2026	Partial	Mar and Jun–Sep 2025 missing
VXA0 total return	Annual	2023 – 2026 YTD	Complete	2026 is through ~Aug and will move
VXA0 total return	Monthly	Jan – Dec 2025	Complete	—
Issuance (US)	Annual	2023 – 2025	Complete	Provider definitions differ materially
Issuance (US)	Quarterly	Q1'23 – Q1'26	Partial	Q3'24 and Q2'25 unconfirmed
Issuance (global)	Quarterly	2025 – Q2'26	Partial	2023–24 quarterly global not pulled
S&P 500	Monthly	2023, 2025, 2026	Partial	2024 monthly detail missing except Dec close

Caveats that change how a number should be read

- **FRED's HY OAS free window is now three years** (from 4 Sep 2023). Anything earlier requires ICE Data Indices or an archive such as YCharts.
- **MOVE 2023–2024 has no free month-end series.** Confirmed anchors are the ~199 March-2023 peak, the above-140 October-2023 stretch, the implied 96.67 2024 close, and “mostly below 120 through 2024”. Do not draw a line through them.
- **VXA0 figures are total returns** as reported by Calamos from ICE BofA Global Research. The +6.4% 2026 YTD runs through roughly August and will move.
- **Issuance totals vary by provider**, by inclusion criteria (144A vs registered, mandatory vs vanilla), and by rounding. Cite the specific provider on every issuance chart.
- **Do not splice HFR indices.** The “almost 6% through July” convert-arb figure reported by Bloomberg is a separate HFR index tracking 120 funds and \$84bn — not the HFRX Convertible Arbitrage Index used here.
- **No MSCI ACWI series was pulled.** Use the MSCI factsheet or an ACWI ETF proxy for a global equity comparison.

6. Interpretation

The convert-arb resurgence is corroborated across independent datasets. As volatility normalised — HY OAS compressing from ~4.0% in late 2023 to 2.63% by August 2026, MOVE from a ~199 March-2023 peak to the low-60s and mid-70s across 2025–2026 — the strategy's profit engine shifted from equity beta toward structural mechanics: cheap new-issue pricing at roughly 2 points, record issuance supplying fresh mispricings, and rich single-stock volatility from AI-infrastructure and crypto-linked issuers.

The allocator-facing point is the 2025 comparison. VXA0's +18.0% marginally beat the S&P 500's +17.9%, but that is a long-only convertible index carrying equity beta. The market-neutral HFRX Convertible Arbitrage sleeve returned +12.78% with near-zero equity beta — a materially different risk profile for a return in the same neighbourhood. Meanwhile Bloomberg reported convert-arb inflows on track for their biggest annual jump in eighteen years.

What would change the read

- **Thesis weakens** if HY OAS breaks back above ~4% or MOVE sustainably re-crosses ~120. The “normalised volatility, structural alpha” story would give way to beta-driven returns.
- **Thesis strengthens** if cheapness widens back toward 2.5+ points alongside continued record issuance — that combination is the constructive setup.
- **Watch the Q1 2026 cheapness print.** At 1.1 points (and 0.1 in February), new paper is priced close to fair. If that persists, the structural edge that drove 2023–2025 is thinning, regardless of what issuance does.

Charting recommendations

- **Standardise on month-end** across every series so the panels align. Pull VIX and HY OAS directly from FRED as CSV for full granularity.
- **Flag MOVE 2023–2024 explicitly as partial** wherever it appears. Complete it from a Bloomberg or ICE terminal, or the convextrade year pages (/history/2023, /2024, /2026).
- **Treat the Matthews South quarterly points as the canonical cheapness series**, and fill Q2 2025, Q3 2023 and Q2 2024 from their individual quarterly posts before publishing that chart.
- **Normalise issuance to a single scope** — US or global — before charting, to avoid mixing the \$124bn, \$108.7bn and \$140–167bn figures on one axis.
- **Annotate April 2025 on every panel.** It is the one event that shows up in all of them.

7. Sources and refresh paths

Series	Provider	Location	Access and refresh note
VIX	FRED — VIXCLS	fred.stlouisfed.org/series/VIXCLS	Free. Download CSV; daily 1990→present.
MOVE	Convex Trade	convextrade.com/metrics/move-index	Free. Year pages /history/<year> hold monthly O/C/H/L.
MOVE (alt)	Yahoo Finance ^MOVE	finance.yahoo.com/quote/%5EMOVE/history/	Free, monthly toggle, manual pull.
HY OAS	FRED — BAMLH0A0HYM2	fred.stlouisfed.org/data/BAMLH0A0HYM2	Free but only a rolling 3-year window.
HY OAS (pre-2023)	ICE Data Indices / YCharts	—	Required for Jan–Aug 2023 month-ends.
Cheapness	Matthews South	matthewssouth.com — quarterly reviews	Free. One post per quarter; fill gaps here.
HFRX Conv. Arb.	Hedge Fund Research	hfr.com/media/performance-notes/	Free monthly notes; check index label.
VXA0 / VNEW	Calamos snapshot (ICE BofA data)	calamos.com — US Convertible Market Snapshot	Free monthly PDF.
Issuance (US)	Matthews South; Bloomberg	matthewssouth.com	Bloomberg is paywalled; MS posts are free.
Issuance (global)	Numerix; BofA; Dealogic	numerix.com ; ionanalytics.com	Numerix and ION summaries are free.
S&P 500	multpl.com	multpl.com/s-p-500-historical-prices/table/by-free/	Free monthly close table.
Global equity proxy	MSCI / ACWI ETF	msci.com factsheet	Not pulled in this pack — see §5.

Reproducing this pack

Every number in this document lives in a CSV under `convertible_arb/data/`. `build_charts.py` renders the eight figures from those CSVs; `build_pdf.py` assembles this PDF from the same CSVs and the rendered figures. To refresh a series, edit its CSV and re-run both scripts — the charts and the tables update together, so they cannot drift apart. Colours follow a colourblind-validated palette; the three categorical hues used here pass CVD separation, normal-vision separation, lightness and chroma checks, and every series carries a direct label as well as its colour.

A note on method: where a period could not be confirmed from a real source, it is absent from the data files, absent from the charts, and named in §5. No cell in this pack was filled by interpolation, carry-forward, or estimate, except the two figures explicitly marked “anchor-approx” and “anchor-implied” in the MOVE anchor table.